

SELF-DEFENCE

Even the largest plant-eating dinosaurs risked being hunted and killed by meat-eating dinosaurs. Over time herbivores developed specialized body defences for survival. These included horns, spikes, spines, and heavy tails that could inflict terrible injuries.



BONY PLATES

Covering the head of *Eupocephalus*, these bony plates provided protection against the jaws and teeth of meat-eating dinosaurs.



SPINY SKULL

A thick skull topped with spines protected a *Sauropelta's* vulnerable brain.



SHARP HORNS

Huge plant-eater *Triceratops* had extremely long, sharp horns, which it used to fight off predators, such as the giant meat-eating *Tyrannosaurus*.



TAIL CLUB

Some plant-eaters, particularly ankylosaurs, had heavy, club-like tails made of fused bone that could break a predator's leg.



SPIKY TAIL

The *Stegosaurus* had very sharp spikes on the end of its tail that could inflict terrible injuries on an opponent.



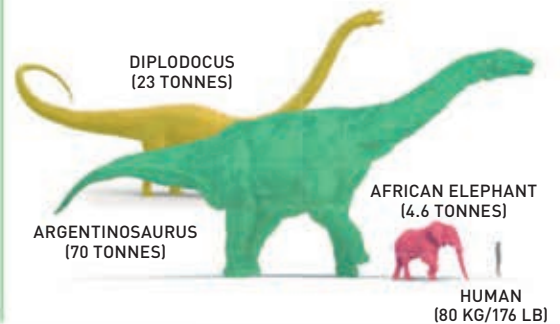
WHIP-LIKE TAIL

It is suggested that the mighty *Diplodocus* used its long tail like a whip to defend itself against attackers.

THE HORNS OF TRICERATOPS WERE AN AMAZING 1 M (3 FT) IN LENGTH

HEAVYWEIGHTS

Like humans, elephants, and other animals, dinosaurs were vertebrates: they had an internal skeleton with a backbone to support their bodies. Many, though, were much heavier. At 70 tonnes, *Argentinosaurus* was 15 times heavier than an elephant.



ORNITHOPODS

Ornithopods, including *Iguanodon*, lived 145–66 million years ago. They could stand on two legs to reach into trees and could chew plants very efficiently. *Corythosaurus*, for instance, had hundreds of teeth for grinding plants.



TITANOSAURUS



BARAPASAURUS



PLATEOSAURUS



DICRAEOSAURUS



HYSIOPHODON



MUTTABURRASAURUS



LESOTHOOSAURUS



LEAELLYNASAURA



HETERODONTOSAURUS



DRYOSAURUS

CORYTHOSAURUS



EDMONTOSAURUS



PARASAUROLOPHUS



TENONTOSAURUS



IGUANODON



MAIASAURA

ANKYLOSAURS AND RELATIVES

Looking rather like prehistoric armoured tanks or armadillos, ankylosaurs had bony plates over their head and shoulders to protect them from predators. They had short, thick legs to support their heavy bodies.



PSITTACOSAURUS



PROTOCERATOPS



MINMI



EUOPOCEPHALUS



SAUROPELTA



ANKYLOSAURUS



GARGOYLEOSAURUS



GASTONIA



EDMONTONIA